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What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Meta Platforms** agreed to an \$18 billion settlement with 48 state attorneys general, bringing an end to a massive federal trial over social media's harm to teenagers. **A1**

◆ **Nvidia** reported record sales of \$96.2 billion, lifting its shares higher in after-hours trading as a forecast of accelerating growth helped calm rising anxiety about the viability of the AI trade. **A1**

◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** slipped, leaving the S&P 500 little changed and the Dow and Nasdaq down 0.2% and 0.1%, respectively. **B11**

◆ **Google** moved a team focused on the risks and societal impact of artificial intelligence out of Google DeepMind, the research lab developing its frontier AI models. **B1**

◆ **Vanguard Group** struck a deal to acquire fintech platform Altruist for about \$4 billion to advance its push into financial advice. **B1**

◆ **A cyberattack** at medical-device maker Boston Scientific triggered a global outage of key operational technology, leaving the company unable to fill orders. **B1**

◆ **Ben & Jerry's** is poised to name three new independent directors to anchor the restructuring of its board, following a long search for suitable candidates. **B2**

◆ **Siemens Energy** said it is preparing to spin off its Transformation of Industry division and is exploring potential ownership structures. **B2**

◆ **Abercrombie & Fitch's** second-quarter sales climbed 4.8% to \$1.27 billion, exceeding Wall Street expectations for \$1.25 billion. **B3**

Worldwide

◆ **The FDA** approved a Revolution Medicines drug that in a late-stage trial helped pancreatic-cancer patients live nearly twice as long as those on chemotherapy alone. **A1**

◆ **The air war** between Russia and Ukraine entered a new phase as expanded aerial arsenals met inadequate air defenses, resulting in a rising civilian toll. **A1**

◆ **CIA Director** John Ratcliffe's surprise visit to Moscow this week was to deliver a warning to Russia not to attack NATO countries. **A7**

◆ **U.S. officials** said they disrupted a China-linked hacking operation that broke into U.S. government networks and critical infrastructure, while going to great lengths to hide its tracks. **A3**

◆ **A lawyer** for Fed governor Lisa Cook told the White House that its allegations she committed mortgage fraud are unfounded, a response to the Trump administration's new threat to fire her. **A2**

◆ **The Trump administration** paused the processing of immigrant visas to train visa officers on new guidance on applicants' financial self-sufficiency. **A3**

◆ **Florida Gov. Ron DeSantis** said the use of automated license-plate readers is "out of control" as debates continue across the U.S. over Flock Safety's AI-enabled cameras. **A3**

◆ **An inquest** was opened into the death of Jason Arday, a Cambridge University professor who faced a storm of plagiarism accusations. **A6**

◆ **Died: Tim Curry**, 80, "Rocky Horror" villain. **A5**

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Meta Settles Child-Safety Suit

Company to pay up to \$18 billion and safeguard its apps for underage users

By MEGHAN BOBROWSKY

Meta Platforms agreed to an \$18 billion settlement with 48 state attorneys general, bringing an end to a massive federal trial over social media's harm

to teenagers and ushering in a new era of tech companies having legal responsibility for their platforms.

Under the settlement, Meta also agreed to make sweeping changes to its services, Facebook and Instagram, including implementing a default two-hour time limit on its apps for users under 18.

In a unique setup, Meta will pay out only 70% of the settle-

ment unless TikTok and YouTube, which is owned by Alphabet, also agree to set default one-hour time limits a day on their apps for underage users and each pay the states about \$5.3 billion. Meta will only pay the remaining 30% of its settlement, also \$5.3 billion, if the two other companies agree to the terms.

The settlement will be distributed to the signing states

in annual installments over a 10-year period based on their populations. It includes 48 states and four U.S. jurisdictions: the District of Columbia, Puerto Rico, American Samoa and Northern Mariana Islands. New Mexico, which sued Meta in a similar trial this spring and won, and Florida aren't now part of the settlement.

Other agreed platform
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FDA Clears Drug for Pancreatic Cancer

By XAVIER MARTINEZ

For four decades, cancer researchers fought to disable a stubborn mutation that made pancreatic cancer a death sentence—to little avail.

Now, doctors have a medicine that targets the mutation. The Food and Drug Administration's approval of the drug from Revolution Medicines on Wednesday marks a milestone in treatment of one of the most intractable kinds of tumors.

"This is life-altering," said Carla Kurkjian, an oncologist at Mercy Hospital in Oklahoma City, who wasn't involved in the studies. "Not just for patients, as far as helping them extend their lives beyond anything we'd ever seen, but for us as physicians, to be able to have a different conversation than we've had for so long."

The drug, called Rasonque, helped subjects in a late-stage study live more than 13 months, nearly twice as long as those on chemotherapy alone. When presented at the world's largest gathering of cancer researchers last spring, the results drew a nearly minute-long standing ovation.

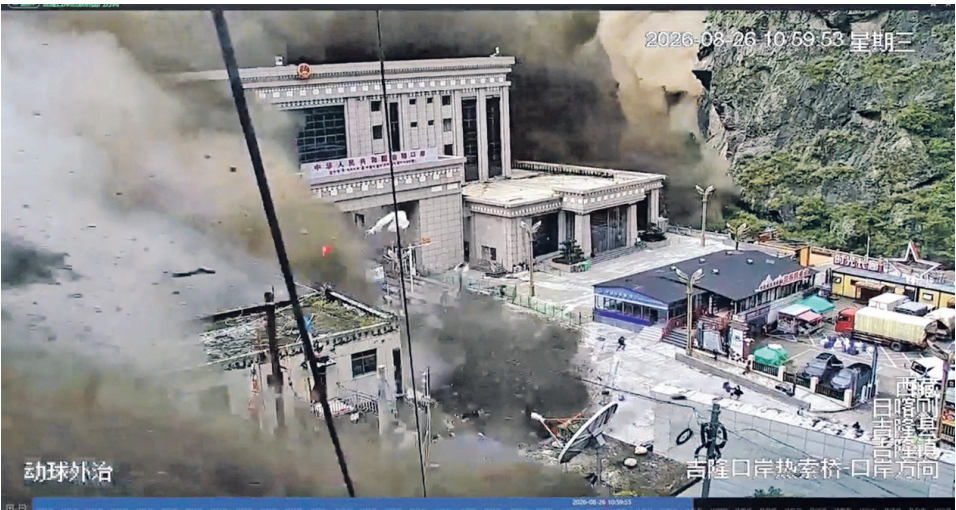
The drug does have side effects, including a harsh rash across the body and gastrointestinal issues.

Former Sen. Ben Sasse of Nebraska, who went public in the spring with what he described as a significant reduction in his tumors while in a clinical trial of the drug, appeared on television with his face covered in red blotches.

RevMed said the drug will cost \$39,800 a month, or more than \$477,000 a year. The company's stock closed up nearly 2% Wednesday in Nas-

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Lethal Walls of Water Hit Himalayas



ENGULFED: A flash flood crashes into the Gyirong Port building on the Nepal-China border in video footage Wednesday. At least 157 were killed and hundreds were missing in the region. **A7**

Nvidia Forecasts 70% Rise In Revenue In 2028

By ROBBIE WHELAN

Nvidia reported record sales of \$96.2 billion on Wednesday, sending its shares higher in after-hours trading as a forecast of accelerating growth helped calm rising anxiety throughout the market surrounding the viability of the artificial-intelligence trade and fears about overspending on AI infrastructure.

For the quarter ended in July, Nvidia reported a 4% rise in sales, which were higher than the \$92.3 billion analysts polled by FactSet had expected. Net income of \$59.7 billion and earnings per share of \$2.46 also beat analyst expectations by wide margins.

The crucial data-center segment, which includes most of the AI servers for which Nvidia is best-known, produced sales of \$89 billion.

Analysts had expected \$86.3 billion in sales.

Nvidia's shares gained more than 4% in after-hours trading after Chief Financial Officer Colette Kress, speaking on a conference call with investors and analysts, said the company expects revenue to grow 70% in 2028.

A flurry of dealmaking activity and product-related news over the past few months has thrust Nvidia, the world's largest publicly traded company and dominant designer of advanced computer chips, even closer to the center of the AI boom.

The \$5 trillion technology behemoth said earlier this month it would team up with a who's-who of top Wall Street investment firms to provide guarantees for up to \$500 billion in data-center financing in order to better help its customers afford the company's chips.

Shortly afterward, Nvidia agreed to backstop a massive Ohio data-center project by OpenAI that could leave the company on the hook for billions of dollars if plans to lease it fall through.

These and other recent developments—including reports of sharp price increases on Nvidia's servers due to the capacity crunch in memory chips and the chip company's ambitious investment in designing AI models to fend off China—have raised investors' eyebrows in recent weeks. Nvidia's stock

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INSIDE



JASON GAY

A scramble to ban pros from campus is latest chaos in freewheeling college football. **A12**

The Fall of the 'Nostradamus of AI'

A 24-year-old investor attracted billions to his fund before turning cautionary tale

By Berber Jin, Ben Cohen and Anissa Gardizy

For the past few years, at happy hours and dinner parties in San Francisco, Leopold Aschenbrenner kept confusing people by sharing his favorite outlandish idea.

He wanted to buy galaxies. Some of his friends weren't always sure what to make of Aschenbrenner's intergalactic ambitions. He once left the room and they debated whether he was referring to physical galaxies or a type of private plane.

No, he assured them when he came

back. He meant galaxies.

His idea was that advances in artificial intelligence would soon unlock resources on a cosmic scale, enabling humans to colonize faraway planets. He planned to save money now so he could spend on galaxies, he told them, and make his mark across the universe.

To almost everyone in this world,

outside the AI bubble of Silicon Valley, the idea of scooping up property rights outside of Earth might sound improbable. But in Aschenbrenner's world, that sort of fervent belief was among the reasons the 24-year-old investor was hailed as a visionary.

Since graduating from Columbia University in 2021 as the class valedictorian at age 19, he has worked his way into the upper echelons of technology. He spent time working out of now-convicted

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The New Cure for Career Burnout: Clown School

Permission granted to get weird and fail spectacularly; red nose not required

By GRACE YOON

For months, the running joke at Philippe Gaulier's famed clown school outside of Paris was that Jack Grossman was going to die alone.

Then, Grossman was paired with Zoe Wohlfeld and instructed to imitate boiling milk.

The pair dragged a white sheet onto the stage, climbed underneath and jumped up

and down. Gaulier snorted, a rare sign of approval from the exacting clown instructor, who was known for his blunt critiques and caustic insults.

Not long after, Grossman and Wohlfeld began dating. Today, they produce and perform clown shows around the globe together.

Clowning is opening a new world for a new generation. No longer just the realm of circus

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Russia-Ukraine War Enters Deadlier Phase

By MARCUS WALKER

A Russian barrage of missiles and drones hit a children's hospital, a school, apartments and warehouses around Kyiv last week, killing at least 16 people. Ukraine, lacking Patriot interceptors, didn't shoot down any of Russia's ballistic missiles.

Ukraine's response this week included a drone strike that caused a fire at one of Russia's largest oil refineries, near Nizhny Novgorod, on Wednesday. Meanwhile, in the central Russian region of Tambov, a ware-

house belonging to e-commerce brand Wildberries burned.

The air war between Russia and Ukraine has entered a new phase. With expanded aerial arsenals and inadequate air defenses, both sides are bludgeoning each other in a fight that is causing a widening swath of destruction and a rising civilian toll.

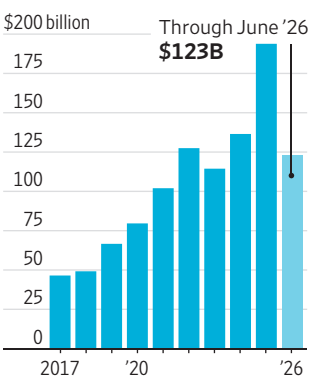
Moscow is betting it can crush the will of Ukraine's civilian population, giving it the breakthrough that has eluded its army in eastern Ukraine.

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Vietnam No. 1 In U.S. Surplus

Vietnam's U.S. trade surplus is now biggest of any country. **A5**

Vietnamese exports to the U.S.



Source: U.S. Census Bureau